Sodium

Sodium is essential for many body activities. It is taken in the diet as salt.

Sources: Common salt, sodium chloride is also found in certain foods like fish, meat, eggs and seasoned foods.



Daily requirements: 8-10 gms

Functions

- It helps in transmission of nerve impulses
- Maintenance of body fluids and electrolytes balance
- Smooth functioning of nerves, muscles and body cells

Potassium

Most of the potassium present inside the cells.

Sources: Fresh vegetables, citrus fruits, milk, guava and amla.



Functions

- Involved in various biochemical activities of the cells.
- Transmission of nerve impulses.
- Maintenance of electrolyte balance and contraction of muscles.

Daily requirements: 2-5 gms

Phosphorous

Most of the phosphorus present in the bones as inorganic form. Few amount resent inside the cells.

Sources: Whole grain cereals and flours, legumes, oatmeal, cheese, nuts, fish



Functions

- Gives rigidity to bones and teeth
- Regulates pH of the blood and urine
- Important in energy metabolism
- Phosphorus compounds are necessary for carbohydrate metabolism and for the calcification of bones and teeth
- Needed for transport of fatty acids

Iron

The amount of iron presents in the adult human body is very small, but it is very important substance and essential for the maintenance of life. 75% of total body iron present in the blood.

Sources: Liver, meat, fish, eggs, cereals, pulses,

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